

Pixar SQL Analysis — Interview Questions

1. ROI + Success Classification — Which films are actually successful? Calculate $ROI = (Revenue - Budget) / Budget$. Classify films as Blockbuster, Hit, Average, or Flop. Find the count of films in each category and the average IMDb score per category.
2. Revenue vs Ratings Paradox — Do higher ratings always mean higher revenue? Rank films by IMDb score and worldwide revenue. Find films where the rating rank and revenue rank differ significantly.
3. Genre Profitability — Which genre actually makes money? Join films with genre data. Calculate average ROI per genre and total revenue per genre. Find the most profitable genre by ROI and the most earning genre by revenue.
4. Director Impact Analysis — Do some directors guarantee success? Group by director and calculate average revenue, average IMDb score, and total films. Find directors with high consistency and high success rate.
5. Runtime Optimization — Is there an ideal movie length? Group runtime into <90, 90–100, 100–110, and 110+ minute buckets. Calculate average revenue and average IMDb score for each bucket.
6. Awards vs Revenue Reality Check — Do awards actually matter? Compare average revenue for films with no awards, 1 award, and 2+ awards. Also compare average IMDb score.
7. Domestic vs International Strategy — Which films depend more on international audiences? Calculate domestic revenue percentage and international revenue percentage. Find films with at least 60% international revenue.
8. Time Trend Analysis — How has Pixar evolved over time? Calculate year-wise total revenue and average IMDb score. Use `LAG()` to find year-over-year revenue growth.
9. Top Performers per Year — What is the best-performing film each year? Use `ROW_NUMBER()`, partition by year, order by worldwide revenue, and return the top film for each year.
10. Hidden Gems Detection — Which films have low budgets but high returns? Find films with a budget below the average budget and revenue above the average revenue. Identify the most efficient films.